

Word family: **fair / fairer / fairest / fairly / fairness / unfair / unfairly / unfairness**

Base word: fair

Comparative: fairer

Superlative: fairest

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, also **noun** and **adverb** in some uses

Related forms:

* **fair** (adj.) — 公平的；合理的；相當好的；淺色的；晴朗的

* **fair** (n.) — 市集；展覽會；嘉年華式活動

* **fairly** (adv.) — 公平地；相當；頗為

* **fairness** (n.) — 公平；公正

* **unfair** (adj.) — 不公平的

* **unfairly** (adv.) — 不公平地

* **unfairness** (n.) — 不公平；不公正

* **fair-minded** (adj.) — 公正客觀的

* **fairground** (n.) — 遊樂場；嘉年華場地

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **firm but fair**

* **fair treatment**

* **fair decision**

* **fair rule**

* **fair price**

* **fair deal**

* **fair share**

* **fair chance**

* **fair amount / number**

* **fair condition**

* **fairly good**

* **fair hair / skin**

* **fair weather**

* **trade fair**

* **book fair**

* **job fair**

* **science fair**

* **county fair**

* **fair play**

* **fair and square**

* **to be fair**

* **it's only fair**

* **no fair**

* **unfair advantage**

Meaning in this passage

> He was firm, but ****fair****, and that balance is not easy to find.

Here, ****fair**** means:

****treating people according to reasonable rules, without favouritism or unjust advantage — 公平的；公正的；公道的****

Mr Chan could enforce rules and standards, but he treated students reasonably and did not favour stronger students over weaker ones.

****中文翻譯：****

他很有原則，但同時也很****公平 / 公道****。

So here:

****firm but fair = 有原則，但處事公平合理****

1. ****fair (待人公平的) — 公平的；公正的；公道的****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He was firm, but ****fair****.

他很有原則，但同時也很****公平****。

Practice 2

> She is a strict but ****fair**** teacher.

她是一位要求嚴格但很****公道的老師****。

Practice 3

> A good manager should be ****fair**** to everyone.

好經理應該****公平對待每一個人****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair = 按合理標準對待所有人，不偏袒任何一方，也不給予不合理的優待或懲罰****

2. ****be fair to someone — 公平對待某人****

Practice 1

> The teacher was always ****fair to weaker students****.

老師一直****公平對待能力較弱的學生****。

Practice 2

> You need to be ****fair to both sides****.

你需要****公平對待雙方****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be fair to someone = 以同樣合理的標準對待某人，不偏心或歧視****

3. ****fair treatment — 公平待遇****

Practice 1

> Everyone deserves ****fair treatment****.

每個人都應得到****公平待遇****。

Practice 2

> The workers demanded ****fair treatment****.

工人要求得到****公平對待****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair treatment = 按合理和一致的標準對待某人****

4. ****fair decision / judgment — 公平合理的決定 / 判斷****

Practice 1

> I think the judge made a **fair decision**.

我認為裁判作出了一個**公平的決定**。

Practice 2

> We need a **fair judgment** based on the evidence.

我們需要根據證據作出**公正判斷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair decision/judgment = 沒有偏見，並基於合理原則作出的決定或判斷

5. **fair rule / system** — 公平的規則 / 制度

Practice 1

> The school needs a **fair system** for dealing with complaints.

學校需要一套處理投訴的**公平制度**。

Practice 2

> The rules should be **fair to everyone**.

規則應該對所有人都**公平**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair rule/system = 對不同的人採用合理、一致標準的規則或制度

6. **fair share** — 公平的一份；應得份額

A very common expression.

Practice 1

> Everyone should do their **fair share** of the work.

每個人都應該做自己**應做的那一份工作**。

Practice 2

> She received her **fair share** of the money.

她得到自己**公平應得的那一份錢**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair share = 按情況或貢獻合理分配後某人應得到的一份

7. **fair price** — 公道價格；合理價格

Here **fair** means reasonable rather than specifically “equal.”

Practice 1

> They offered me a **fair price** for the car.

他們給我的車開了一個**合理公道的價錢**。

Practice 2

> Customers want good quality at a **fair price**.

顧客希望以**合理價格**買到優質產品。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair price = 對買賣雙方而言合理、不過高也不過低的價格

8. **fair deal** — 公平合理的交易 / 待遇

Practice 1

> Workers deserve a **fair deal**.

工人應該得到**公平合理的待遇**。

Practice 2

> I just want a **fair deal**.

我只想要一個**公平合理的安排**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****fair deal = 各方得到合理待遇或條件的協議 / 安排****

9. ****fair chance — 公平機會；合理機會****

This expression can have two related readings.

Practice 1

> Every student deserves a ****fair chance**** to succeed.

每個學生都應有****公平的成功機會****。

Practice 2

> Give him a ****fair chance**** to explain himself.

給他一個****合理充分的機會****解釋自己。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair chance = 不受不合理阻礙、能夠充分嘗試或證明自己的機會****

10. ****it's only fair — 這才公平；這是應該的****

Practice 1

> You helped me yesterday, so ****it's only fair**** that I help you today.

你昨天幫了我，所以今天我幫你也是****應該的 / 這才公平****。

Practice 2

> ****It's only fair**** to give everyone the same amount of time.

給每個人同樣的時間才算****公平****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****it's only fair = 某個做法在道理上是合理、公平而應該的****

11. ****to be fair — 公道地說；平心而論****

A very common discourse marker.

Practice 1

> **To be fair**, he did apologize.

平心而論，他確實有道歉。

Practice 2

> **To be fair**, the task was difficult.

公道地說，那項工作確實很難。

MCQ-ready definition:

to be fair = 引出一個較平衡、公正、替另一方考慮的觀點

12. **fair enough — 有道理；可以接受**

A common conversational expression.

Practice 1

> “I need more time.”

> “**Fair enough.**”

「我需要多一點時間。」

「**有道理 / 可以理解。**」

Practice 2

> **Fair enough**, let's try your idea.

好吧，也有道理，我們試試你的想法。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair enough = 表示接受對方的理由、看法或安排是合理的

13. **fair play — 公平競爭；公平行事**

Practice 1

> Sport should encourage **fair play**.

運動應該鼓勵**公平競爭**。

Practice 2

> The rules are designed to ensure **fair play**.

這些規則旨在確保**公平比賽**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair play = 遵守規則、不作弊並公平對待競爭者的行為

14. **fair and square** — 光明正大地；公平地

Practice 1

> She won **fair and square**.

她是**光明正大地**贏的。

Practice 2

> They beat us **fair and square**.

他們**堂堂正正地**擊敗了我們。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair and square = 完全按照規則、沒有作弊或不正當手段地

15. **no fair!** — 不公平！

Informal, especially common in children's speech.

Practice 1

> “You got two pieces!”

> “**No fair!**”

「你有兩件！」

「**不公平！**」

Practice 2

> That's **not fair**!

那**不公平**！

MCQ-ready definition:

no fair / not fair = 表示認為某個安排、結果或待遇不合理

16. **fair** (合理的 ; 合情合理的) — 合理的 ; 適當的

This is broader than interpersonal justice.

Practice 1

> That's a **fair question**.

那是一個**合理的問題**。

Practice 2

> It's a **fair criticism**.

那是個**合理的批評**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair = 有充分理由、合乎情理，不過分或不合理的

17. **fair comment / criticism** — 合理評論 / 批評

Practice 1

> I think that's a **fair comment**.

我認為那是個**合理的評論**。

Practice 2

> His criticism was harsh but **fair**.

他的批評雖然嚴厲，但算是**合理公道**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair comment/criticism = 有事實或合理理由支持、不算過分的評論 / 批評****

18. ****fair (相當的 ; 不少的) — 相當多的 ; 頗大的****

A major quantity/degree sense.

Practice 1

> We still have a ****fair amount of work**** to do.

我們還有****相當多工作****要做。

Practice 2

> A ****fair number of students**** attended the event.

有****相當多學生****出席了活動。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a fair amount/number = 數量頗多、相當可觀，但未必非常大量****

19. ****a fair bit / a fair way — 頗多 ; 頗遠****

Especially common in BrE.

Practice 1

> We've still got a ****fair bit of work**** left.

我們仍有****頗多工作****未完成。

Practice 2

> The station is a ****fair way**** from here.

車站離這裏****頗遠****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a fair bit/way = 相當多 / 相當遠****

20. **fair chance / possibility (相當可能) — 頗有可能**

A probability use distinct from “equal opportunity.”

Practice 1

> There's a **fair chance** of rain tonight.

今晚**頗有可能**下雨。

Practice 2

> He has a **fair chance of winning**.

他**頗有機會**勝出。

MCQ-ready definition:

a fair chance of X = X 發生的可能性相當不低

This is why **fair chance** needs context: it may mean **公平機會** or **頗大機會**.

21. **fair (尚可的 ; 相當好的) — 尚可的 ; 不錯的**

A moderate-quality evaluation.

Practice 1

> His performance was **fair**, but not excellent.

他的表現**尚可**，但並不出色。

Practice 2

> The food was **fair** for the price.

以這個價錢來說，食物算是**不錯 / 尚可**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair = 質素尚可、達到合理水平，但並不特別優秀

22. **fair condition — 狀況尚可**

Practice 1

> The old building is still in **fair condition**.

這座舊建築的狀況仍算**尚可**。

Practice 2

> The second-hand car is in **fair condition**.

這輛二手車的車況**普通至尚可**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair condition = 狀態可以接受，但不算很好

23. **fairly** (相當；頗) — 相當；頗為

This is one of the most important family extensions.

Practice 1

> The test was **fairly difficult**.

測驗**頗難**。

Practice 2

> She speaks English **fairly well**.

她英文說得**相當不錯**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fairly + adjective/adverb = 程度相當、頗為，但通常不到非常強烈

24. **fairly** (公平地) — 公平地；公正地

Practice 1

> The teacher treated everyone **fairly**.

老師**公平地**對待所有人。

Practice 2

> We need to divide the work **fairly**.

我們需要**公平地**分配工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

fairly = 以公平、不偏袒任何一方的方式

25. **fairly** (完全地 / 真正地 , 在某些搭配中) — 實在地 ; 簡直

A stronger, somewhat literary/BrE extension in expressions such as **fairly certain, fairly burst**, though less central for learners.

Practice 1

> I was **fairly certain** that he would come.

我**相當肯定**他會來。

Practice 2

> The room was **fairly packed**.

房間裏**相當擠迫**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fairly = 在某些搭配中強調程度相當高 ; 實際強度依語境而定

For learner use, the safest core is still **「相當 / 頗」**.

26. **fair hair** — 淺色頭髮 ; 金 / 淺棕頭髮

A completely different descriptive sense.

Practice 1

> She has **fair hair** and blue eyes.

她有**淺色頭髮**和藍眼睛。

Practice 2

> He was a **fair-haired** child.

他小時候有一頭**淺色頭髮**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair hair = 顏色較淺的頭髮，通常指金色或淺棕色

27. **fair skin / complexion** — 白皙 / 淺色皮膚

Practice 1

> She has very **fair skin**.

她的皮膚很**白皙**。

Practice 2

> People with **fair complexions** may burn easily in strong sunlight.

皮膚較**白皙**的人在強烈陽光下較容易曬傷。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair skin/complexion = 膚色較淺、較白的皮膚

28. **fair** (天氣：晴朗的) — 晴朗的；天氣良好的

A traditional but still standard weather sense.

Practice 1

> The forecast says the weather will remain **fair**.

天氣預報說天氣會維持**晴朗**。

Practice 2

> We had **fair weather** for most of the trip.

旅程大部分時間都有**良好晴朗的天氣**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair weather = 天氣晴朗、乾燥，沒有明顯惡劣天氣****

29. ****fair-weather friend — 酒肉朋友；只能共樂不能共患難的人****

A fixed figurative expression.

Practice 1

> He turned out to be a ****fair-weather friend****.

原來他只是個****只能共樂、不能共患難的朋友****。

Practice 2

> Real friends stay; ****fair-weather friends**** disappear when things get difficult.

真正的朋友會留下，而****酒肉朋友****遇到困難就會消失。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair-weather friend = 只在情況順利時才支持你，遇到困難便離開的朋友****

30. ****fair (noun : 市集；展覽會；嘉年華) — 市集；展覽會****

A major completely different noun branch.

Practice 1

> We went to the local ****fair**** on Saturday.

星期六我們去了本地的****市集 / 嘉年華****。

Practice 2

> The school held a summer ****fair****.

學校舉辦了一個夏季****嘉年華會****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair = 有攤位、活動、商品或娛樂項目的公共活動或市集****

31. **trade fair — 貿易展覽會**

Practice 1

> The company exhibited its products at a **trade fair**.

公司在**貿易展覽會**展示產品。

Practice 2

> Buyers from many countries attended the **trade fair**.

來自多個國家的買家參加了**貿易展**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****trade fair = 公司展示產品、與買家或業界人士交流的商業展覽****

32. **book fair — 書展**

Practice 1

> We bought several books at the **book fair**.

我們在**書展**買了幾本書。

Practice 2

> The annual **book fair** attracts thousands of visitors.

一年一度的**書展**吸引數以千計訪客。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****book fair = 展示、推廣和銷售書籍的大型活動****

33. **job / career fair — 招聘會；職業展**

Practice 1

> Students attended a **career fair**.

學生參加了一個**職業展**。

Practice 2

> I spoke to several employers at the **job fair**.

我在**招聘會**跟幾位僱主談過。

MCQ-ready definition:

job/career fair = 僱主、機構和求職者集中交流招聘及職業資訊的活動

34. **science fair — 科學展覽 / 科學比賽**

Practice 1

> The students presented their projects at the **science fair**.

學生在**科學展覽**展示自己的作品。

Practice 2

> She won first prize at the school **science fair**.

她在學校**科學展**獲得一等獎。

MCQ-ready definition:

science fair = 學生或參加者展示科學實驗、研究或發明的活動

35. **fairground — 嘉年華 / 遊樂場地**

Practice 1

> The children spent the afternoon at the **fairground**.

孩子們下午都在**嘉年華遊樂場**玩。

Practice 2

> The **fairground** was full of rides and food stalls.

嘉年華場地有很多機動遊戲和食物攤位。

MCQ-ready definition:

****fairground = 舉行嘉年華、市集或機動遊戲活動的場地****

36. ****fair (sports : 合規的 ; 有效的) — 合規的 ; 有效的****

A domain-specific sports sense.

Practice 1

> The referee ruled the challenge ****fair****.

裁判判定這次攔截****合乎規則****。

Practice 2

> The ball landed in ****fair territory****.

球落在****有效區域****內。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair = 在某項運動規則下合法、有效、不屬犯規的****

37. ****fair ball — 界內球 ; 有效球****

Especially baseball.

Practice 1

> The umpire called it a ****fair ball****.

裁判判定那是****界內球****。

Practice 2

> The ball landed just inside the line and was ruled ****fair****.

球剛好落在線內，因此被判為****有效球****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****fair ball = 在棒球等運動中落於規定有效範圍內的球****

38. **fair-minded — 公正客觀的**

Practice 1

> A judge needs to be **fair-minded**.

法官需要**公正客觀**。

Practice 2

> She is thoughtful and **fair-minded**.

她做事細心，而且**公正不偏**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fair-minded = 願意客觀考慮各方觀點，不帶偏見的

39. **fairness — 公平；公正**

Practice 1

> Students appreciated his sense of **fairness**.

學生很欣賞他的**公平處事**。

Practice 2

> The decision raised questions about **fairness**.

這個決定令人質疑其**公平性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fairness = 對不同人士採用合理一致標準、不偏袒的特質

40. **unfair — 不公平的；不合理的**

Practice 1

> The punishment was **unfair**.

這個懲罰很**不公平**。

Practice 2

> It's **unfair** to blame her for everything.

把所有責任都怪在她身上很**不公平 / 不合理**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfair = 沒有按合理、公正或一致標準處理的

41. **unfair advantage** — 不公平優勢

Practice 1

> The rule gave one team an **unfair advantage**.

這條規則給其中一隊帶來**不公平優勢**。

Practice 2

> Cheating gives players an **unfair advantage**.

作弊令參賽者取得**不公平優勢**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfair advantage = 透過不公平條件或手段取得的優勢

42. **unfairly** — 不公平地

Practice 1

> He felt that he had been treated **unfairly**.

他覺得自己受到**不公平對待**。

Practice 2

> Don't judge her **unfairly**.

不要**不公平地**評價她。

MCQ-ready definition:

unfairly = 以不公正、不合理或偏袒的方式

Important distinction 1: **fair vs equal**

This is crucial.

equal

everyone gets the same amount/treatment.

fair

everyone gets reasonable treatment according to relevant circumstances.

These can overlap, but:

fair does not always mean identical

For example, giving a weaker student extra support can be **fair** even though it is not mathematically equal treatment.

That fits your passage particularly well.

Important distinction 2: **fair vs just**

fair

very common, everyday.

just

more formal and often connected to moral/legal justice.

> a fair teacher

公平的老師

> a just society

公正的社會

Important distinction 3: **fair vs impartial**

fair

reasonable and just.

impartial

does not favour either side.

An impartial judge should also be fair, but **impartial** focuses specifically on neutrality.

Important distinction 4: **fair vs unbiased**

unbiased

free from prejudice or preference.

fair

broader: the resulting treatment or decision is reasonable.

> unbiased analysis

沒有偏見的分析

> fair decision

公平的決定

Important distinction 5: **fair vs reasonable**

These often overlap.

fair

often emphasizes justice and proper treatment.

reasonable

emphasizes logic, moderation, or acceptability.

> fair treatment

公平待遇

> reasonable price

合理價格

But **fair price** works because the price is reasonable to both sides.

Important distinction 6: **fair vs kind**

A teacher can be:

- * kind but unfair
- * fair but not especially warm
- * both kind and fair

Fair is about standards and treatment, not affection.

Important distinction 7: **fair vs firm**

This is exactly the contrast in your sentence.

firm

doesn't easily give way on rules/standards.

fair

applies those rules reasonably and without bias.

So:

> **firm but fair**

means:

有原則，但不偏心、不苛刻

These qualities complement rather than contradict each other.

Important distinction 8: **fair vs strict**

strict

rules are strongly enforced.

fair

rules are reasonable and consistently applied.

A teacher can be strict and fair at the same time.

Important distinction 9: **fair chance = equal opportunity vs probability**

Ambiguous phrase:

give someone a fair chance

= 給公平 / 充分機會

there's a fair chance of rain

= 下雨的可能性頗高

Context determines the branch.

Important distinction 10: **fair = reasonable vs fair = moderate quality**

Compare:

> a **fair price**

合理價格

> a **fair performance**

尚可的表現

The first is **reasonable**; the second is **moderately good / acceptable**.

Important distinction 11: **fair vs good**

good

clearly positive.

fair

in quality ratings often means only:

acceptable / average-to-moderate

So:

> condition: fair

usually ranks below:

> condition: good

Important distinction 12: **fairly vs very**

fairly

usually moderate:

= 頗 ; 相當

very

stronger intensifier.

> fairly difficult

頗難

> very difficult

非常難

But exact strength depends somewhat on adjective and dialect.

Important distinction 13: ****fairly = fairly treated vs fairly difficult****

Same adverb, different branch:

> treated ****fairly****

被公平對待

> ****fairly**** difficult

頗難

This is a significant learner trap.

Important distinction 14: ****fair hair vs light hair****

****fair hair****

traditional/common especially in BrE for naturally light-coloured hair.

****light hair****

also understandable, but less idiomatic for describing a person's natural colouring.

Important distinction 15: ****fair skin does not mean beautiful skin****

Here:

****fair skin = 淺色 / 白皙皮膚****

It has nothing to do with ****fair = 公平****.

Important distinction 16: ****fair weather vs good weather****

****fair weather****

specifically relatively clear, dry, settled weather.

****good weather****

broadly positive judgment.

So **fair weather** has a more traditional/weather-report flavour.

Important distinction 17: **fair-weather friend**

The expression does not mean:

> a friend who likes sunny weather.

It is metaphorical:

stays while conditions are good → leaves when life becomes difficult

Hence:

只能共樂、不能共患難的人

Important distinction 18: **fair noun vs market**

fair

an organized event where goods, ideas, projects, jobs, etc. are displayed or offered.

market

primarily a place/system where things are bought and sold.

A book fair or job fair may not function like an ordinary marketplace.

Important distinction 19: **fair vs exhibition**

exhibition

focuses on displaying things.

fair

often combines:

- * display
- * stalls
- * sales
- * networking
- * entertainment

There is substantial overlap in compounds like **trade fair**.

Important distinction 20: **fairness vs equality**

equality

equal status, rights, treatment, or amounts.

fairness

reasonable and just treatment.

Again:

fairness can sometimes require different support for different needs

This distinction fits Mr Chan's treatment of weaker students particularly well.

Family-extension note

Fair is a major polysemy family with several genuinely distinct branches:

1. **justice / impartial treatment**

- * fair teacher
- * fair decision
- * fair treatment
- * fairness

2. **reasonable / appropriate**

- * fair price
- * fair criticism
- * fair deal

3. **moderate quantity/probability**

- * a fair amount
- * a fair number
- * a fair chance

4. **moderate quality**

- * fair condition
- * fair performance

5. **degree adverb**

- * fairly difficult
- * fairly well

6. **light colouring**

- * fair hair
- * fair skin

7. **good weather**

- * fair weather

8. **event / market noun**

- * trade fair
- * book fair
- * job fair
- * science fair

9. **sports legality**

- * fair play
- * fair ball

10. **opposite family**

- * unfair
- * unfairly
- * unfairness

These branches are far enough apart that **fair** absolutely deserves full learner-facing polysemy treatment rather than one broad Chinese translation.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
fair person/teacher	公平的；公道的	just treatment
fair to someone	公平對待某人	impartial treatment
fair treatment	公平待遇	justice
fair decision	公平決定	unbiased judgment
fair share	應得份額	reasonable division
fair price	公道價格	reasonable price
fair deal	公平待遇 / 交易	reasonable arrangement
fair chance	公平機會	proper opportunity
it's only fair	這才公平	justified action
to be fair	平心而論	balanced viewpoint
fair enough	有道理；可以接受	reasonable
fair play	公平競爭	rule-following
fair and square	光明正大地	honestly/fairly
fair question/comment	合理問題 / 評論	reasonable
fair amount/number	相當多	considerable quantity
fair chance of X	頗有可能 X	moderate probability
fair performance	尚可表現	moderate quality
fair condition	狀況尚可	acceptable quality
fairly difficult	頗難	moderate degree
fairly treated	被公平對待	justly
fair hair	淺色頭髮	light colouring
fair skin	白皙 / 淺色皮膚	light complexion
fair weather	晴朗天氣	clear weather
fair-weather friend	酒肉朋友	unreliable friend
fair (noun)	市集；展覽會	public event
trade fair	貿易展	commercial exhibition
book fair	書展	book event
job fair	招聘會	employment event
science fair	科學展	science exhibition
fairground	嘉年華場地	fair venue
fair ball	界內球	valid sports play
fair-minded	公正客觀的	impartial mindset
fairness	公平；公正	quality of justice
unfair	不公平的	unjust
unfair advantage	不公平優勢	improper benefit
unfairly	不公平地	unjustly

For your original sentence

> He was firm, but **fair**, and that balance is not easy to find.

Here:

fair = 公平的 ; 公正的 ; 公道的

The speaker is describing **how Mr Chan treated students**, not saying that he was merely “nice.”

The previous sentence gives us the evidence:

> He never made weaker students feel small.

So his **fairness** involved:

- * not humiliating weaker students,
- * not showing favouritism,
- * applying standards reasonably,
- * combining discipline with respect.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他很有原則，但同時也很**公道**，而這種平衡其實並不容易做到。

For this passage, **「公道」** is especially natural because it captures **fairness in the way a person treats others**, while **「公平」** is the cleanest direct dictionary definition.